

DOLLAR TREE

How We Work

Specialist Process Guide for Packaging Compliance AI

The Team Guide explains what the platform can do.

This guide explains how our team uses it: queue discipline, decision rules, when to escalate, and how we talk to vendors.

1. Your daily rhythm

Start and end every day in My Work. The platform tracks assignments, due dates and escalations for you — your job is to work them in the right order.

Work your queue in this order

- **1. Overdue reviews** — anything past its SLA date comes first, no exceptions.
- **2. Escalated items** — reviews escalated to you carry findings someone already judged serious.
- **3. High-risk queue** — packages with Critical findings or risk scores in the red.
- **4. Oldest assigned first** — then work the rest of My Reviews oldest-first so nothing quietly ages out.

Daily habits

- **Check My Notifications** — at the start of each session — mentions, status changes and new assignments land there.
- **Clear My Tasks** — before picking up new reviews; open tasks are commitments you've already made.
- **Record decisions same-day** — if you've finished reading a package, record the decision. A finished-but-undecided review is invisible work.

Rule of thumb

If a package will sit with you for more than a day, say why — either a comment on the package or a task assigned to whoever you're waiting on. Silence is how reviews get lost.

2. How to read AI findings

The AI is a first-pass reader, not a decision-maker. Treat its output the way you'd treat a thorough junior analyst: usually right, always worth verifying on anything that matters.

- **Verify Critical and Major findings yourself** — open the cited regulation (one click from the finding) and confirm the rule actually applies to this product and claim.
- **Check the detected text on the artwork** — make sure the finding points at real label copy, not an OCR misread. The proof pin shows you where the AI was looking.
- **Low-confidence findings are questions, not violations** — the platform labels uncertain findings for human review. Answer the question — confirm or dismiss with a note — rather than passing them through.
- **Dismissals need a reason** — when you dismiss a finding, write one line on why. That note feeds Compliance Memory and stops the same false positive from wasting the next reviewer's time.
- **Suggested fixes are drafts** — check them against Approved Language before sending wording to a vendor. If approved phrasing exists for the situation, use it verbatim.

Never do this

Never approve a package on the AI grade alone, and never tell a vendor 'the AI flagged it' as the whole justification. Every finding we act on should be traceable to a regulation, an internal standard, or approved language.

3. When to run Deep Analysis

Deep Analysis runs the package through the heavier reasoning AI tier. It is slower and costs more, so use it deliberately — not as a second opinion on everything.

Run it when

- **The product is regulated territory** — disinfectants and pesticides (EPA), food and supplements (FDA), children's products (CPSC), or anything with health or efficacy claims.
- **The standard pass looks wrong** — findings feel off, contradictory, or suspiciously clean for a crowded label.
- **You're about to reject** — a rejection is expensive for the vendor; make sure the case is as strong and complete as it can be.

Skip it when

- **Simple artwork, clean pass** — a basic package with no claims and no findings doesn't need a second, slower read.
- **The issue is already obvious** — if you can see the violation and cite the rule, decide — don't run more analysis to confirm what you know.

4. Decision rules

Three outcomes exist: Approve, Revise, Reject. Every decision needs a decision note — one or two sentences is fine. The note is what the audit trail, the vendor conversation, and future reviewers rely on.

Approve

- **All Critical and Major findings resolved or dismissed with reasons** — no exceptions for Critical.
- **Claims substantiated** — every efficacy or origin claim either has support or has been removed from the artwork.
- **You'd put your name on it** — because you are — approvals are recorded with your name and timestamp.

Revise (the default outcome)

- **Fixable problems** — wrong wording, missing required elements, formatting issues. List exactly what must change; copy suggested fixes or approved language into the note or annotations.
- **Export the annotated proof** — so the vendor sees each issue pinned on their own artwork, with the required correction next to it.

Reject

- **Reserve for fundamental problems** — unsubstantiatable claims central to the product, prohibited ingredients or content, or repeated failure to fix the same Critical issues.
- **Second set of eyes** — before rejecting, flag a manager or senior specialist in the comments. Rejections trigger vendor escalations — the case needs to be airtight.

Severity floor

A package with an unresolved Critical finding can never be Approved, whatever the deadline pressure. If the business needs it faster, escalate — don't lower the bar.

5. When and how to escalate

Escalation is a normal tool, not an admission of failure. Use it early rather than sitting on something you're unsure about.

- **Regulatory ambiguity** — you and the cited regulation genuinely don't resolve the question — escalate to the Regulatory lead rather than guessing.
- **SLA at risk** — you can see you won't make the date. Escalating two days early beats explaining two days late.
- **Vendor pushback on a Critical finding** — if a vendor disputes a Critical or legal-risk finding, that conversation moves up a level; don't negotiate compliance one-on-one.
- **Cross-category products** — if a package straddles categories (e.g. a food item with a toy inside), escalate so routing puts both specialties on it.

Use the platform's escalation action on the review itself — not a hallway conversation — so the escalation, its reason, and its resolution are all on the record.

6. Working with vendors

- **Everything through the platform** — vendor-facing feedback goes out as the exported annotated proof plus the decision note. No side-channel spreadsheets or marked-up email screenshots.
- **Use Approved Language** — when telling a vendor what wording to use, pull it from the Approved Language glossary so every vendor hears the same phrasing.
- **Be specific and finite** — a Revise decision should read like a checklist the vendor can complete in one round. 'Fix compliance issues' is not feedback.
- **New versions, fresh eyes** — when revised artwork arrives, add it as a new version and re-run analysis. Compare versions side by side; confirm each requested fix landed before looking at anything new.
- **Supplier portal data is theirs alone** — never share one vendor's findings, scores or artwork with another vendor, in any form.

7. Working alongside each other

- **Respect the lock** — if a review shows another specialist active on it, don't record decisions over them — comment or ping instead.
- **Comments are the record** — decisions and disagreements about a package belong in its comment thread, where the next person can find them — not in chat apps.
- **Tasks over memory** — if something needs doing later or by someone else, create a task on the package. Assigned tasks survive vacations; mental notes don't.
- **Feed Compliance Memory** — good dismissal notes and clear decision notes make the AI and the team smarter on the next similar package. Write them like you're helping future-you.

8. Quick reference

Before you approve — 30-second checklist

- 1. — All Critical/Major findings resolved or dismissed with written reasons.
- 2. — Claims checked against substantiation; origin and warning statements present where required.
- 3. — Wording matches Approved Language where it exists.
- 4. — Decision note written — what you checked and why it passes.

Who to go to

- **Tool questions** — Ask AI (top bar) or Training > FAQ.
- **Regulatory interpretation** — escalate on the review to the Regulatory lead.
- **Access or role problems** — your manager or a platform administrator via Training > Contact Support.
- **Bugs or odd AI behavior** — Training > Contact Support, with the package number.

This guide sets the floor, not the ceiling. When your judgment says a package needs more scrutiny than the process requires — follow your judgment, and leave a note explaining why.